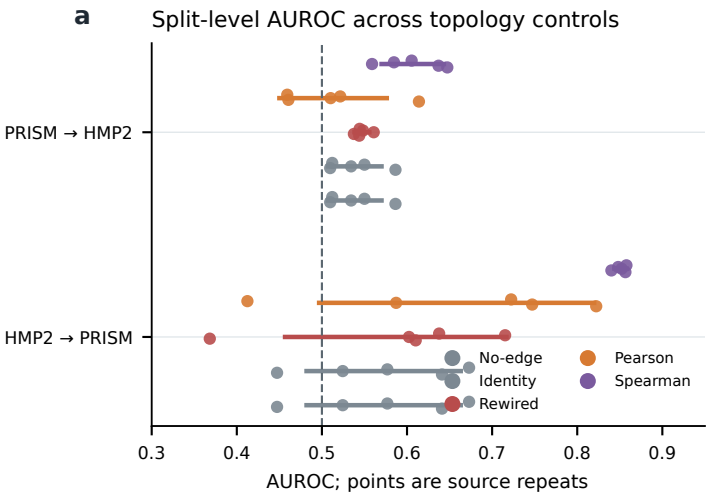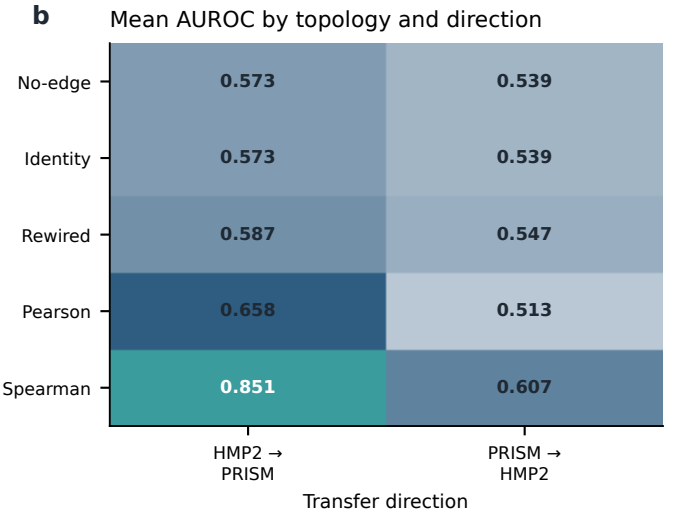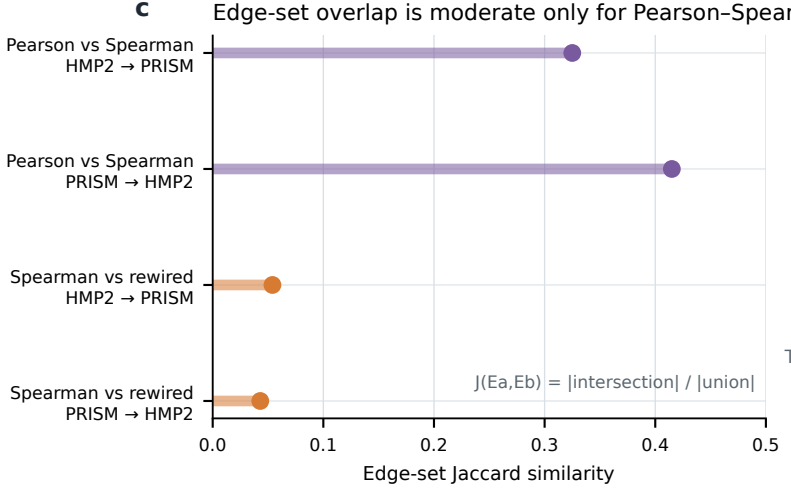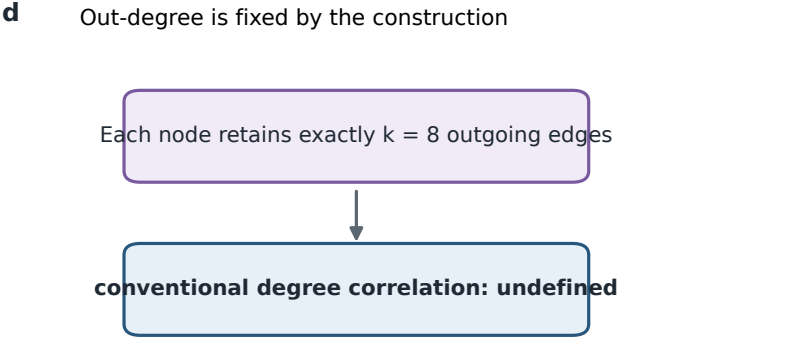Topology ablations localize the relational contribution